

Outlook

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Analytics needs a source-of-truth decision

Morning,

I need help with something that sounds simple but probably is not.

A requested analysis changes depending on whether the team starts from transaction, debit-order, account-status or customer-contact records. Failure anecdotes are beginning to drive decisions, although retries and late posting may be making the problem look larger than the affected-customer population.

The questions I would ask in the room are:

1. What would we expect to see if one source is updated retrospectively?
2. What evidence would instead support that matching logic is joining unrelated records?
3. How do we rule out that the sources record different stages of one event?

This has returned because the previous answer was useful but not strong enough to become a standing rule. Use May 2020 as the new evidence point rather than recycling the earlier conclusion. Please work towards the source precedence rule and the cases that must remain explicitly unresolved. A useful output would be a model-ready table, data dictionary and an honest baseline.

Use transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; debit-order mandates, collection dates, suspensions and cancellations; monthly account snapshots, status events, limits, product enrolments and signatories; customer contacts, complaints and suggestions. One caution: Do not force agreement by dropping exceptions; preserve contradictory evidence for owner review.

Regards